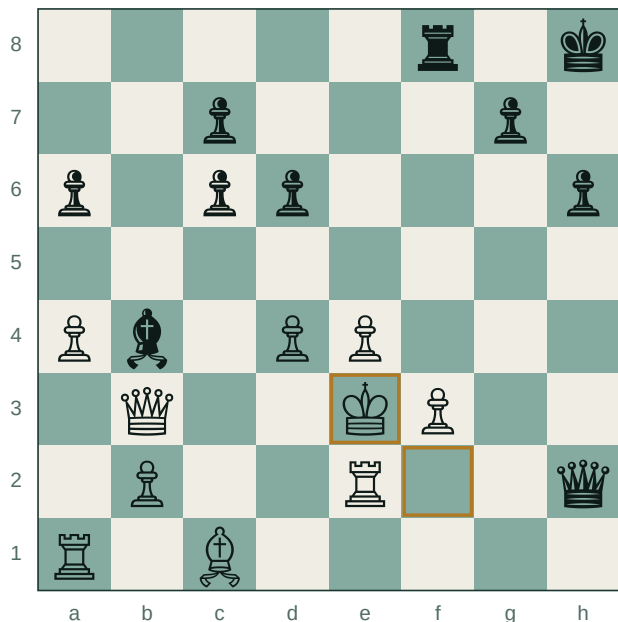


# Skewers: Black, move 25

Skewers

Black to move



Previous move: 25.Ke3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**25...Rxf3+ 26. Kxf3 Qh3+ 27. Kf2 Qxb3**

**25...Rxf3+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on f3. Recorded reply: **26.Kxf3**.

**26...Qh3+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **27.Kf2**.

**27...Qxb3** The queen captures the queen on b3.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on e3. Geometrically undefended: queen on b3 and rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.